a. Pure ō-stems.

§ 365. Sing.

Nom.	**giefu, -o,** *gift*	**ār,** *honour*
Acc.	**giefe**	**āre**
Gen.	**giefe**	**āre**
Dat.	**giefe**	**āre**

Plur.

Nom. Acc.	**giefe, -a**	**āre, -a**
Gen.	**giefa, (-ena)**	**āra, (-na, -ena)**
Dat.	**giefum**	**ārum**

The prim. Germanic forms were: Sing. nom. ***ȝeþō,** acc. ***ȝeþōn** (cp. Gr. χώρᾱν), gen. ***ȝeþōz** (Goth. **gibōs**), dat. ***ȝeþai;** Plur. nom. acc. ***ȝeþōz** (Goth. **gibōs**), gen. ***ȝeþōn** (Goth. **gibō**), dat. ***ȝeþōmiz** (Goth. **gibōm**). The acc. gen. and dat. sing. and the nom. acc. pl. regularly fell together in **-æ** in prehistoric OE. (§ **217**). The **-æ** remained in the oldest period of the language and then later regularly became **-e.** In the nom. sing. the **-ō** became **-u** and then regularly disappeared after long stem-syllables (§ **215**). In late OE. the gen. sing. often ended in **-es** after the analogy of the masc. **a**-stems; and sometimes the nom. of the short stems was used for all cases of the singular. The regular ending of the gen. pl. is **-a,** but in late OE. the gen. pl. often ended in **-(e)na** after the analogy of the **n**-stems (§ **403**). On the ending **-um** of the dat. plural, see § **218,** 5. It is difficult to account for the **-a** in the nom. acc. pl. in WS. and Ken., and for the **-a** in the oblique cases of the fem. nouns ending in **-ung** in these dialects. Seeing that the gen. sing. and nom. pl. originally had the same ending **-ōz** and that both cases ended in **-æ** in the oldest OE., the **-a** in the nom. pl. cannot be a regular development from older **-æ.** It is sometimes assumed that **-a** is the regular

development of prim. Germanic -ōz in OE., and that what is called the gen. sing. is morphologically the dat., but against this assumption it should be pointed out that in the oldest period of the language the gen. and dat. sing. and nom. plural had all the same ending. Short stems with **a** often have **æ** beside **a** in the acc. gen. and dat. sing. and nom. acc. pl., as **læþe, ræce,** beside **laþe, race.**

§ **366.** Like **giefu** are declined **caru,** *care*; **coþu,** *disease*; **cwalu,** *violent death*; **daru,** *injury*; **denu,** *valley*; **faru,** *journey*; **hogu,** *solicitude*; **laþu,** *invitation*; **lufu** (also weak), *love*; **nafu,** *nave* (*of wheel*); **notu,** *use*; **racu,** *account, narrative*; **rudu,** *redness*; **sacu,** *strife*; **sagu,** *saw*; **sc(e)amu,** *shame*; **scinu,** *shin*; **scolu,** *troop*; **snoru,** *daughter-in-law*; **stalu,** *theft*; **swaþu,** *track*; **talu,** *tale, number*; **þracu,** *violence, combat*; **waru,** *people*; **wracu,** *revenge*; &c.

§ **367.** Like **ār** are declined a large number of nouns, as **æsp,** *aspen-tree*; **bād,** *pledge*; **bǣr,** *bier*; **beorc,** *birch-tree*; **bōt,** *advantage*; **brōd,** *brood*; **eax,** *axis*; **eaxl,** *shoulder*; **fēol,** *file*; **gād,** *goad*; **glōf,** *glove*; **heall,** *hall*; **heord,** *herd, flock*; **hwīl,** *space of time*; **lād,** *way, journey*; **lāf,** *remnant*; **lār,** *learning*; **lēod,** *nation*; **lind,** *linden, shield*; **mearc,** *boundary*; **mēd, meord,** *reward*; **mund,** *hand*; **rād,** *ride, riding*; **reord,** *voice, language*; **rōd,** *cross*; **rūn,** *secret*; **scand,** *disgrace*; **scofl,** *shovel*; **sealf,** *ointment*; **sorg,** *sorrow*; **stund,** *period of time, hour*; **tang,** *tongs*; **þearf,** *need*; **þēod,** *nation*; **þrāg,** *time, period*; **wamb,** *stomach*; **weard,** *protection*; **wund,** *wound*; &c. **brū,** *eyebrow,* has nom. acc. pl. **brūa** beside **brūwa,** gen. **brūna,** dat. **brūum** beside **brūwum.**

§ **368.** Sing.

Nom.	**firen,** *crime*	**sāwol,** *soul*
Acc.	**firene**	**sāwle**
Gen.	**firene**	**sāwle**
Dat.	**firene**	**sāwle**

	PLUR.		
Nom.	Acc.	**firene, -a**	**sāwle, -a**
	Gen.	**firena**	**sāwla**
	Dat.	**firenum**	**sāwlum**

In originally trisyllabic words the final **-u** regularly disappeared in the nom. sing. when the stem and the medial syllable were short, but remained when the stem-syllable was long and the medial syllable short (§ **216**). Then after the analogy of words like **firen,** the final **-u** was also dropped in words like **sāwol.** The medial vowel regularly disappeared in the inflected forms after long stems, but remained after short (§ **221**). The nouns of this class do not have the ending **-(e)na** in the gen. plural.

§ **369.** Like **firen** are declined **bisen, bisn,** *example*; **byden,** *bushel*; **ciefes,** *concubine*; **feter,** *fetter*; **feþer,** *feather*; **netel,** *nettle*; **spinel,** *spindle*; **stefn,** *voice*; but **egenu,** *chaff.*

§ **370.** Like **sāwol** are declined **ādl,** *disease*; **ceaster,** *city, fortress*; **frōfor** (also masc.), *consolation*; **nǣdl,** *needle*; **wōcor,** *increase, usury.*

§ **371.**	Nom. **strengþu, -o,** *strength*	**leornung,** *learning*
	Acc. Gen. Dat. **strengþe**	**leornunge, -a**

The fem. abstract nouns ending in prim. Germanic **-iþō** regularly syncopated the medial **i** (§ **221**) and in the oldest period of the language retained the final **-u** in the nom. (§ **216**). Then at a later period the **-u** (**-o**) was often dropped after the analogy of words like **ār** (§ **367**). At a still later period the nom. with and without the final **-o** came to be used for all cases. The abstract nouns in **-ung** regularly syncopated the final **-u** in the nom. (§ **216**).

§ **372.** Like **strengþu, -o, strengþ** are declined **cȳþþu, cȳþ(þ),** *native country*; **fǣhþ(u),** *feud*; **gesǣlþ(u),** *prosperity*;

hlīewþ(u), *shelter*; **mǣgþ(u)**, *family, kindred*; **þīefl (u)**, *theft*; **wrǣþþ(u)**, *anger, wrath*; for further examples, see § **613**.

§ **373**. Like **leornung** are declined **ǣfnung**, *evening*; **ǣring**, *dawn*; **geþafung**, *consent*; **lēasung**, *falsehood*; **rihtung**, *direction*; **swinsung**, *melody*; **wēnung**, *hope, expectation*; for further examples, see § **615**.

b. **jō**-STEMS.

§ **374**. SING.

Nom.	**hen(n)**, *hen*	**gierd**, *rod*
Acc.	**henne**	**gierde**
Gen.	**henne**	**gierde**
Dat.	**henne**	**gierde**
PLUR.		
Nom. Acc.	**henne, -a**	**gierde, -a**
Gen.	**henna**	**gierda**
Dat.	**hennum**	**gierdum**

It is necessary to distinguish between those stems which were originally long and those which became long by the West Germanic doubling of consonants (§ **254**). The **j** regularly disappeared after causing umlaut of the preceding vowel, and then the **-u** in the nom. sing. being preceded by a long stem also disappeared (§ **215**), so that the endings of the **jō**-stems are the same as the long **ō**-stems except that the gen. pl. never has the ending **-(e)na** (§ **365**). On the final double consonants in the nom. singular, see § **259**.

§ **375**. Like **hen(n)** are declined **benn**, *wound*; **brycg**, *bridge*; **bytt**, *flagon*; **cribb**, *crib*; **crycc**, *crutch*; **ecg**, *edge*; **hell**, *hell*; **nytt**, *use, profit*; **sciell**, *shell*; **secg**, *sword*; **sibb**, *relationship*; **slecg**, *sledge-hammer*; **synn**, *sin*; **syll**, *sill, threshold*; **wynn**, *joy*. On **hæcc**, *gate, hatch*; **sæcc**, *strife*, see § **55**, Note 3.

§ **376**. Like **gierd** are declined **æx**, *axe*; **bend** (also masc. and neut.), *band*; **blīþs**, **bliss**, *bliss*; **hild**, *war, battle*; **hind**, *doe*; **līþs**, **liss**, *favour, kindness*; **milts**, *mercy, kind-*

ness; **nift**, *niece*; **rest**, *rest*; **sprǣc**, *speech, language*; **wrǣc**, *vengeance*; **wylf**, *she-wolf*; **ȳþ**, *wave*. On the **g** in **cǣg**, *key*; **īeg**, *island*, see §§ **270, 272.**

§ **377.**

	Sing.	Plur.
Nom.	**byrþen(n)**, *burden*	**byrþenne, -a**
Acc.	**byrþenne**	**byrþenne, -a**
Gen.	**byrþenne**	**byrþenna**
Dat.	**byrþenne**	**byrþennum**

In originally trisyllabic words the final **-u** in the nom. singular also regularly disappeared after the medial syllable which became long by the West Germanic doubling of consonants (§§ **216, 254**). The nouns ending in **-en(n)** sometimes took **-u** again in the nom. sing. after the analogy of the short **ō**-stems. In late OE. the double consonants were often simplified in the inflected forms.

§ **378.** Like **byrþen(n)** are declined **candel** (Lat. **candēla**), *candle*; **cnēoris(s)**, *generation*; **hægtes(s)**, *witch*; **biren**, *she-bear*; **fyxen**, *she-fox*; **gyden**, *goddess*; **þyften**, *female servant*; **wiergen**, *she-wolf*; **byrgen**, *tomb*; for further examples, see § **599.** **cōlnes(s)**, *coolness*; **swiftnes(s)**, *swiftness*; **þrīnes(s)**, *trinity*; for further examples, see § **609.** **rǣden(n)**, *arrangement, rule*; **hūsrǣden(n)**, *household*; for further examples, see § **610.**

Note.—A few words simplified the double consonants at an early period and then added **-u** in the nom. singular after the analogy of the short **ō**-stems, as **hyrnetu** beside **hyrnet**, *hornet*; **ielfetu**, *swan*.

c. **wō-stems.**

§ **379.**

	Sing.	
Nom.	**beadu, -o**, *battle*	**mǣd**, *meadow*
Acc. Gen. Dat.	**beadwe**	**mǣdwe**
	Plur.	
Nom. Acc.	**beadwe, -a**	**mǣdwe, -a**
Gen.	**beadwa**	**mǣdwa**
Dat.	**beadwum**	**mǣdwum**

In the nom. singular the prim. Germanic ending **-wō** regularly became **-wu** (§ **214**), then the **w** disappeared before the **-u** (§ **266**). The **-u** remained after consonants preceded by an original short vowel, but disappeared after consonants preceded by a long vowel (§ **215**). When the **-u** was preceded by **a** it combined with it to form a diphthong, as **clēa** from ***cla(w)u**, *claw*, **þrēa** from ***þra(w)u**, *threat* (§ **75**), pl. nom. acc. **clēa**, dat. **clēam** from ***cla(w)um**; beside the regular nom. sing. forms **clēa**, **þrēa** new nominatives **clawu**, **þrawu** were made from the stem-form of the oblique cases. The final **-u** also regularly disappeared after long vowels and diphthongs (§ **215**), but was restored again from the inflected forms already in the oldest period of the language, as **hrēow**, *repentance*; **stōw**, *place*; **trēow** (§ **90**), *faith, truth.*

In the inflected forms the **wō**-stems had the same endings as the **ō**-stems except that they never had the ending **-(e)na** in the gen. plural. On the svarabhakti vowel in forms like gen. **beaduwe** beside **beadwe**, see § **220**.

§ **380.** Like **beadu** are declined **sinu**, **sionu**, *sinew*; **sceadu**, *shadow*; and the plurals **frætwe**, *ornaments*; **geatwe**, *armaments, armour.*

§ **381.** Like **mǣd** are declined **blōd(es)lǣs**, *blood-letting, bleeding*; **lǣs**, *pasture.*

3. Feminine Abstract Nouns in -ī.

§ **382.** This declension comprises the fem. abstract nouns formed from adjectives. The stem originally ended in **-īn**, and the nom. in **-ī**, cp. Goth. **mikilei**, *greatness*, **diupei**, *depth*, formed from **mikils**, *great*, **diups**, *deep*, gen. **mikileins**, **diupeins** (weak declension). The **-īn**, **-ī** were shortened to **-in**, **-i** in prehistoric OE. (§§ **211**, **214**), and then the **i** caused umlaut of the stem-vowel. But already in the oldest period of the language this class of nouns was remodelled on analogy with the short **ō**-stems (§ **365**), so

that the nom. came to end in **-u**, later **-o**, and the oblique cases of the singular in **-e**. At a later period the new nominative came to be used for all forms of the singular and for the nom. acc. plural. Few nouns belonging to this class have a plural.

	SING.	PLUR.
Nom.	**strengu, -o**, *strength*	**strenge, -a; -u, -o**
Acc.	**strenge, -u, -o**	„
Gen.	„	**strenga**
Dat.	„	**strengum**

§ **383.** Like **strengu** are declined **bieldu**, *boldness*; **bierhtu**, *brightness*; **engu**, *narrowness*; **fyllu**, *fullness*; **hǣlu**, *health*; **hǣtu**, *heat*; **hyldu**, *favour*; **ieldu**, *age*; **menigu, mengu**, *multitude*; **oferfierru**, *great distance*; **snytru**, *wisdom*; **þīestru**, *darkness*; **wlencu, wlenc(e)o**, *pride*. See §§ **563, 614.**

4. THE i-DECLENSION.

§ **384.** The **i**-declension comprises masculine, feminine and neuter nouns, and corresponds to the Lat. and Gr. **i**-declension (nom. masc. and fem. Lat. **-is**, Gr. **-ις**, acc. **-im**, **-ιν**; neut. nom. acc. **-e**, **-ι**).

a. Masculine.

§ **385.**

SING.		
Nom. Acc.	**wine**, *friend*	**giest**, *guest*
Gen.	**wines**	**giestes**
Dat.	**wine**	**gieste**
PLUR.		
Nom. Acc.	**wine, -as**	**giestas**
Gen.	**wini(ge)a, wina**	**giesta**
Dat.	**winum**	**giestum**

The prim. Germanic forms were: Sing. nom. ***gastiz**, acc. ***gastin**, gen. ***gastaiz** (cp. Goth. **anstáis**), dat. ***gastai** (cp.

Goth. **anstái**), loc. **ȝastī* from Indg. **ǫhostēi*; Plur. nom. **ȝastīz* older **-ijiz** (Goth. **gasteis**), acc. **ȝastinz* (Goth. **gastins**), gen. **ȝasti(j)ōn*, dat. **ȝastimiz* (Goth. **gastim**). The endings **-iz, -in** of the nom. acc. sing. regularly became **-i** in prehistoric OE. The **-i** caused umlaut of the stem-vowel and then disappeared after long stems (§ **215**), but remained after short stems and later became **-e** (§ **215**, Note). The regular ending of the gen. sing. would be **-e** (§ **217**), the **-es** is from the **a**-stems. The dat. sing. ended in **-i** (later **-e**) in the oldest OE. and corresponded to the locative ending **-ī** (§ **334**, Note). The prim. Germanic nom. pl. ending **-īz** regularly became **-i**, later **-e**, which remained in the oldest period of the language. But already at an early period the nom. pl. was re-formed after the analogy of the masc. **a**-stems and then later the old ending **-e** was only preserved in a few plurals, especially in names of peoples, as **Dene**, *Danes*; **Engle**, *the English*; **Mierce** (gen. **Miercna**), *Mercians*; **Norþhymbre**, *Northumbrians*; **Seaxe** (gen. **Seaxna**), *Saxons*; **ielde**, *men*; **ielfe**, *elves*; **līode, lēode**, *people*. The ending **-i(j)ōn** regularly became **-i(j)a** which has only been preserved in a few words with short stems, as **Deni(ge)a, wini(ge)a**. The ending **-a** is from the gen. pl. of the **a**- and consonantal stems. The dat. pl. would regularly have ended in **-im**, but it had **-um** from the other classes of nouns. Apart from the few words mentioned above, the long **i**-stems have the same endings as the masc. **a**-stems and are only distinguishable from them by the presence or absence of umlaut.

§ **386**. Like **wine** are declined a large number of nouns, as **bile**, *beak*; **bite**, *bite*; **bryce**, *breach*; **bryne**, *burning*; **byge**, *curve*; **byre**, *son*; **ciele**, *cold*; **cyme**, *advent*; **cyre**, *choice*; **cwide**, *saying, speech*; **dene**, *valley*; **drepe**, *stroke, blow*; **dryre**, *fall*; **dyne**, *din*; **flyge**, *flight*; **gripe**, *grasp*; **gryre**, *terror*; **gyte**, *pouring forth*; **hæle** (orig. a cons. stem, see § **414**), *man, hero*; **hefe**, *weight*; **hege**, *hedge*;

hrine, *touch*; **hryre**, *fall*; **hyge**, *mind*; **hype**, *hip*; **hyse** (pl. **hys(s)as**), *youth, son*; **ile** (pl. **il(l)as**), *sole of the foot*; **lyge**, *falsehood*; **lyre**, *loss*; **mere** (orig. neut.), *lake, pool*; **mete** (pl. **mettas**), *food*; **myne**, *memory*; **ryge**, *rye*; **ryne**, *course*; **scyfe**, *shove*; **scyte**, *shooting*; **sele**, *hall*; **sice**, *sigh*; **slege**, *stroke, blow*; **slide**, *slip*; **slite**, *slit*; **snide**, *incision*; **stæpe**, *step*; **stede**, *place*; **stice**, *stitch*; **stige**, *ascent*; **stride**, *stride*; **swyle**, *swelling*; **þyle**, *orator*; **wlite**, *brightness, beauty*. **bēorscipe**, *feast*; for further examples, see § **611**. **bere** (Goth. ***baris**), *barley*; **ege** (Goth. **agis**), *fear*; **hete** (Goth. **hatis**), *hate*; **mene**, *necklace*; **sige** (Goth. **sigis**), *victory*, originally belonged to the neuter **-os**, **-es**-declension (§ **419**). **ele** (Lat. **oleum**), *oil*, was also originally neuter.

§ **387**. Like **giest** are declined a large number of nouns, as **ǣrist** (also fem.), *resurrection*; **æsc**, *ash-tree*; **blǣd**, *blast, breath*; **blǣst**, *blast*; **brygd**, *brandishing*; **byht**, *bend*; **byrst**, *loss*; **cierm**, *clamour*; **cierr**, *turn, change*; **dǣl**, *part*; **drenc**, *drink*; **dynt**, *dint*; **ent**, *giant*; **feng**, *grasp*; **fiell**, *fall*; **fierst**, *period of time*; **flyht**, *flight*; **fyrs**, *furze*; **glǣm**, *gleam*; **gylt**, *guilt*; **hlīep**, *leap*; **hlyst** (also fem.), *sense of hearing*; **hwyrft**, *turning, circuit*; **hyht**, *hope*; **lǣst**, *track*; **lēc**, *sight, looking at*; **līeg**, *flame*; **list**, *skill, cunning*; **lyft** (also fem.), *air*; **mǣw**, *seagull*; **pliht**, *danger, peril*; **sǣl** (also fem.), *time*; **scenc**, *cup, draught*; **slieht**, *slaughter*; **smīec**, *smoke*; **stenc**, *odour*; **steng**, *pole*; **stiell**, *leap*; **streng**, *string*; **swēg**, *sound, noise*; **swylt**, *death*; **tyht**, *training, instruction*; **þyrs**, *giant*; **wǣg**, *wave*; **wiell**, *spring*; **wielm**, *boiling*; **wrenc**, *trick, stratagem*; **wyrm**, *worm*.

§ **388**. **sǣ**, prim. Germanic ***saiwiz**, *sea*, gen. **sǣs**, dat. **sǣ**, pl. nom. acc. **sǣs**, gen. ***sǣwa**, dat. **sǣm** beside **sǣwum** (a new formation); also fem. gen. dat. **sǣ** beside **sǣwe**; **drȳ**, *magician*, gen. **drȳs**, dat. **drȳ**, pl. nom. acc. **drȳas**, dat. **drȳum**. On the contracted forms, see §§ **139**, **142**.

b. Feminine.

§ **389.**	Sing.		Plur.
	Nom. Acc.	**cwēn,** *queen*	**cwēne**
	Gen.	**cwēne**	**cwēna**
	Dat.	**cwēne**	**cwēnum**

The masc. and fem. **i**-stems were originally declined alike in the sing. and plural. The nom. pl. and the whole of the sing. are regularly developed from the corresponding prim. Germanic forms, as sing. ***kwǣniz, *kwǣnin, *kwǣnaiz, *kwǣnai,** nom. pl. ***kwǣnīz.** The gen. and dat. pl. were new formations as in the masc. **i**-stems. In early Nth. and then later also in WS. and Ken. the acc. sing. often had **-e** after the analogy of the **ō**-stems; and in like manner the nom. acc. pl. often had **-a** already in early OE.

§ **390.** Like **cwēn** are declined **æht,** *property*; **ansīen,** *face*; **bēn,** *prayer*; **benc,** *bench*; **brȳd,** *bride*; **cȳf,** *tub*; **cyst,** *choice*; **dǣd,** *deed*; **dryht,** *troop*; **ēst,** *favour*; **fierd,** *army*; **fȳst,** *fist*; **glēd,** *live coal*; **hǣs,** *command*; **hȳd,** *hide, skin*; **hȳf,** *hive*; **hyrst,** *ornament*; **meaht, miht,** *might, power*; **nīed,** *need*; **scyld,** *guilt*; **spēd,** *success*; **sȳl,** *pillar*; **tīd,** *time*; **þrȳþ,** *strength*; **wǣd,** *garment*; **wēn,** *hope, expectation*; **wist,** *sustenance, food*; **wyrd,** *fate*; **wyrt,** *vegetable, herb*; **ȳst,** *storm.* **duguþ,** *strength,* **geoguþ,** *youth,* **ides,** *woman,* which originally belonged to this declension, went over into the **ō**-declension.

Note.—**æ**, prim. Germanic ***aiwiz,** *divine law,* generally remains uninflected in the sing. and in the nom. acc. plural, but beside the gen. dat. sing. **æ** there also exists **æwe** from which a new nom. **æw** was formed.

§ **391.** A certain number of nouns, which originally belonged to the fem. **i**-declension, partly or entirely became neuter and were then declined like **cynn** (§ **355**) or **hof** (§ **342**) in the singular, and like **hof** in the plural. Such nouns are: **fulwiht, fulluht,** *baptism*; **grīn,** *snare, noose*;

oferhygd, *pride*; **wiht, wuht**, *thing, creature*; nouns with the prefix **ge-**, as **gebyrd**, *birth*; **gecynd**, *nature, kind*; **gehygd**, *mind*; **gemynd**, *memory*; **gesceaft**, *creation*; **geþeaht**, *thought*; **geþyld**, *patience*; **gewyrht**, *merit, desert*; pl. **gedryhtu**, *elements*; **giftu**, *gifts*. In late OE. other fem. **i**-stems also sometimes took the neut. plural ending **-u** (**-o**).

c. Neuter.

§ **392.**

	SING.	PLUR.
Nom. Acc.	**spere**, *spear*	**speru, -o**
Gen.	**speres**	**spera**
Dat.	**spere**	**sperum**

The neuter **i**-stems had originally the same endings as the masculine except in the nom. acc. sing. and plural. The nom. acc. sing. ended in **-i** which regularly disappeared after long stems, but remained after short stems, and then later became **-e** (§ **215**, Note). The nom. acc. pl. ended in **-ī** which would regularly have become **-i** (§ **214**), later **-e**, after short stems, and disappeared after long stems. The nom. acc. pl. ending **-u** (**-o**) was due to the influence of the short neuter **a**-stems. The endings of the other cases are of the same origin as those of the masc. short **i**-stems. The regular form of the nom. acc. singular would be ***spire** (§ **41**) if **spere** originally belonged to the neuter **i**-declension.

§ **393.** Like **spere** are declined **ofdæle**, *downward slope, descent*; **oferslege**, *lintel*; **orlege**, *fate*; **sife**, *sieve*. All these nouns probably belonged originally to the **-os-**, **-es-** declension (§ **419**).

A certain number of neuter nouns which originally belonged partly to the neut. **ja**-stems, and partly to the **-os-**, **-es**-stems are declined like **spere**, except that the stem-syllable being long the final **-e** disappeared in the nom. acc. singular. Such nouns are: **flǣsc**, *flesh*; **flīes**, *fleece*; **hǣl**, *health*; **hilt** (also masc.), *hilt*; **lǣn**, *loan*; **sweng**, *blow*.

gefēg, *joining, joint*; **gegrynd**, *plot of ground*; **gehield**, *watching, protection*; **gehlȳd**, *noise*; **gehnæst**, **-āst**, *collision*; **genyht**, *sufficiency*; **geresp**, *blame*; **gewēd**, *fury, madness*; **geswinc**, *labour, affliction.*

5. The u-declension.

§ **394.** The **u**-declension comprises masculine, feminine and neuter nouns, and corresponds to the Lat. and Gr. **u**-declension (nom. masc. and fem. Lat. **-us**, Gr. **-υς**, acc. **-um**, **-υν**; neut. nom. acc. **-ū**, **-υ**).

a. Masculine.

§ **395.** Sing.

Nom. Acc.	**sunu**, **-o**, *son*	**feld**, *field*
Gen.	**suna**	**felda**
Dat.	**suna**	**felda**
Plur.		
Nom. Acc.	**suna**	**felda**
Gen.	**suna**	**felda**
Dat.	**sunum**	**feldum**

The prim. Germanic forms were: Sing. nom. ***sunuz** (Goth. **sunus**), acc. ***sunun** (Goth. **sunu**), gen. ***sunauz** (Goth. **sunáus**), dat. ***suniwai** (***sunwai**), loc. ***sunau** (Goth. **sunáu**); Plur. nom. ***suniwiz** (Goth. **sunjus**), acc. ***sununz** (Goth. **sununs**), gen. ***suniwõn** (***sunwõn**), dat. ***sunumiz.** The endings **-uz**, **-un** regularly became **-u** in prehistoric OE., and then disappeared after long stems (§§ **211**, **215**), but remained after short stems and later became **-o**. **-auz** regularly became **-a** (§ **217**). The OE. dat. sing. is originally the locative. It is difficult to account for the ending **-a** of the nom. plural, which cannot be a normal development of prim. Germanic **-iwiz** = Indg. **-ewes.** The gen. pl. ending **-a** is from the **a-** and the consonantal stems. The dat. pl. ending **-um** is from older **-umiz.** At a later period the **-u** (**-o**) of the nom. acc. sing.

was often extended to the dat. sing. and nom. acc. pl. in the short stems; and likewise the **-a** of the gen. and dat. sing. to the nom. acc. In late OE. the short stems also often formed their gen. sing. and nom. acc. pl. after the analogy of the masc. **a**-stems. Already at an early period the long stems were often declined entirely like the **a**-stems. Many nouns which originally belonged to this class went over into the **a**-declension in prehistoric OE. without leaving any trace of the **u**-declension, as **ār** (Goth. **áirus**), *messenger*; **dēaþ** (Goth. **dáuþus**), *death*; **feorh** (also neut.), *life*; **flōd**, *flood*; **grund**, *ground*; **lust**, *pleasure, desire*; **scield**, *shield*; **þorn**, *thorn*; **beofor**, *beaver*; **esol**, *ass*; **hungor**, *hunger*; **fiscoþ**, *fishing*; **huntoþ**, *hunting*; for further examples, see § **595**.

§ **396**. Like **sunu** are declined **bregu**, *prince, ruler*; **heoru**, *sword*; **lagu**, *sea, flood*; **magu**, *son, man*; **medu**, **meodu**, *mead* (gen. **meda** beside **medwes**); **sidu**, *custom*; **spitu**, *spit*; **wudu**, *wood*.

§ **397**. Like **feld** are declined **eard**, *native country*; **ford**, *ford*; **gār** (mostly in compounds), *spear*; **hād**, *rank, condition* (for compounds in **-hād**, see § **605**); **hearg**, *temple*; **sēaþ**, *pit, spring*; **weald**, *forest*; **sumor**, *summer*; **æppel** (gen. **æp(p)les**, pl. **ap(p)la** beside **æp(p)las**, and neut. **ap(p)lu**), *apple*; **winter** (pl. neut. **wintru** beside **winter**), *winter*.

b. Feminine.

§ **398**.

SING.		
Nom. Acc.	**duru, -o**, *door*	**hand**, *hand*
Gen.	**dura**	**handa**
Dat.	**dura**	**handa**
PLUR.		
Nom. Acc.	**dura**	**handa**
Gen.	**dura**	**handa**
Dat.	**durum**	**handum**

The masculine and feminine **u**-stems were originally declined alike. In the short stems the nom. acc. sing. was also sometimes used for the dat. sing. and nom. acc. plural; and the gen. and dat. sing. often had **-e** after the analogy of the short **ō**-stems. Beside the regular gen. and dat sing. **dura,** there also occurs **dyre, dyru** with **i**-umlaut after the analogy of the **i**-declension. In the long stems the nom. acc. sing. was sometimes used for the gen. and dative. To the short stems also belongs **nosu,** *nose*; and to the long stems: **cweorn** (also **ō**-declension), Goth. **-qaírnus,** *hand-mill*; **flōr** (also masc.), *floor*; and originally also **cin(n)** (Goth. **kinnus,** Gr. **γένυς**), *chin.*

c. Neuter.

§ **399.** The neuter **u**-stems had originally the same endings as the masculine except in the nom. acc. sing. and plural, the former of which ended in **-u** and the latter in **-ū.** Nth. **feolu, -o,** and the WS. isolated inflected form **fela, feola,** *much, many,* are the only remnants of this declension in OE. **feoh** (Goth. **faíhu**), *cattle,* went over into the **a**-declension in prehistoric OE.

B. The Weak Declension (N-Stems).

a. Masculine.

§ **400.**

Sing.		
Nom.	**guma,** *man*	**frēa,** *lord*
Acc.	**guman**	**frēan**
Gen.	**guman**	**frēan**
Dat.	**guman**	**frēan**
Plur.		
Nom. Acc.	**guman**	**frēan**
Gen.	**gumena**	**frēana**
Dat.	**gumum**	**frēa(u)m**

The prim. Germanic forms were: Sing. nom. *ȝumõ, acc. *ȝumanun, gen. *ȝumenaz (Goth. gumins), dat., properly locative, *ȝumini (Goth. gumin); Plur. nom. *ȝumaniz (Goth. gumans), acc. *ȝumanunz, gen. *ȝumnõn (cp. Goth. aúhs-nē, OE. ox-na, *of oxen*) beside West Germanic *ȝumōnõn (OHG. gomōno, OS. gumono) with -ōnõn from the fem. nouns, dat. *ȝumunmiz beside West Germanic *ȝumō(n)miz (OHG. gomōm) with -ō- from the genitive. In OE. the nom. and acc. sing. and the nom. pl. were regularly developed from the corresponding prim. Germanic forms. The regular form of the gen. and dat. sing. would be *gumen, *gymen, but OE. had levelled out the -an of the acc. sing. before the period of i-umlaut. The gen. pl. can be either from *ȝumanõn with a from the sing. and the nom. plural, or from West Germanic *ȝumōnõn (§§ 217, 222). The dat. pl. was formed direct from ȝum + -um, the ending of the a-stems and the other consonantal stems, or else it is from West Germanic *ȝumō(n)miz. Beside the regular gen. pl. ending -ena, the forms -ana, -ona sometimes occur. The e in -ena was generally syncopated after long stems in poetry and in the names of peoples. On the loss of final -n in Nth., see § 288.

From a morphological point of view the n-stems should be divided into -an, -jan, and -wan stems, but in OE. as in the other Germanic languages all three classes were declined alike. The -jan stems have i-umlaut in the stem-syllable and also gemination of consonants when the stem was originally short, as dēma, *judge*, cȳta, *kite*, becca, *pickaxe*, brytta, *distributor*, *prince*, from prim. Germanic *đōmjõ, kūtjõ, *þakjõ, *þrutjõ.

§ 401. Like guma are declined a large number of nouns, as ācumba, *oakum*; ǣra, *strigil*; ǣrendra, *messenger*; āglǣca, *monster*; anda, *envy*; andsaca, *adversary*; anga, *goad*; apa, *ape*; assa, *ass*; bana, *slayer*; bēna, *suppliant*;

beorma, *barm, yeast*; **bera**, *bear*; **bes(e)ma**, *besom*; **bita**, *bit, morsel*; **blanca**, *horse*; **blōstma**, *blossom*; **boda**, *messenger*; **boga**, *bow*; **bolla**, *bowl*; **brōga**, *terror*; **bucca**, *he-goat*; **bylda**, *builder*; **byrga**, *surety*; **cleofa**, *cleft, cave*; **cnapa**, *boy*; **cnotta**, *knot*; **cofa**, *chamber*; **crabba**, *crab*; **cruma**, *crumb*; **cuma**, *guest, stranger*; **dogga**, *dog*; **dora**, *bumble-bee*; **dropa**, *drop*; **dwolma**, *chaos*; **eafora**, *son*; **fana**, *banner*; **fēþa**, *band of infantry*; **flīema**, *fugitive*; **flota**, *sailor*; **fola**, *foal*; **freca**, *warrior*; **frogga**, *frog*; **fruma**, *beginning*; **gāra**, *corner*; **gealga**, *gallows*; **gealla**, *gall*; **gefēra**, *companion*; **gehola**, *protector*; **gerēfa**, *reeve*; **gerūna**, *councillor*; **gesaca**, *adversary*; **geþofta**, *companion*; **gewuna**, *custom*; **haca**, *hook*; **hafela**, *head*; **hana**, *cock*; **hara**, *hare*; **hunta**, *hunter*; **inca**, *grudge*; **lēoma**, *ray of light*; **lida**, *sailor*; **loca**, *enclosure*; **maga**, *stomach*; **mōna**, *moon*; **naca**, *boat*; **nama**, *name*; **nefa**, *nephew*; **ōga**, *terror*; **ōretta**, *warrior*; **oxa** (pl. **œxen exen**, beside **oxan**, § **107**), *ox*; **plega**, *play*; **pohha**, *pouch, bag*; **prica**, *prick, point*; **rima**, *rim*; **ryþþa**, *mastiff*; **sāda**, *cord, snare*; **scanca**, *shank*; **scaþa**, *foe, enemy*; **scrēawa**, *shrew-mouse*; **scucca**, *demon*; **scu(w)a**, *shadow*; **sefa**, *mind, heart*; **slaga**, *slayer*; **snaca**, *snake*; **sopa**, *sup*; **spāca**, *spoke of a wheel*; **spearwa**, *sparrow*; **staca**, *stake*; **stela**, *stalk*; **steorra**, *star*; **swēora**, *neck*; **swica**, *deceiver*; **swīma**, *giddiness*; **telga**, *branch*; **trega**, *grief, affliction*; **þearfa**, *pauper*; **þūma**, *thumb*; **wela**, *prosperity*; **wita**, *sage, wise man*; **wītega**, *prophet*; **wræcc(e)a** (§ **55**, Note 3), *exile*; **wyrhta**, *worker*; and the pl. **hīwan** (gen. **hīna** beside **hīwna**), *members of a household.*

§ **402**. Like **frēa** are declined **flēa**, *flea*; **gefā**, *foe*; **(ge)fēa**, *joy*; **lēo**, *lion*; **rā**, *roe*; **twēo**, *doubt*; **wēa**, *woe*; and the plural **Swēon**, *Swedes.* See § **139**.

b. Feminine.

§ **403.**

SING.		
Nom.	**tunge,** *tongue*	**bēo,** *bee*
Acc.	**tungan**	**bēon**
Gen.	**tungan**	**bēon**
Dat.	**tungan**	**bēon**
PLUR.		
Nom. Acc.	**tungan**	**bēon**
Gen.	**tungena**	**bēona**
Dat.	**tungum**	**bēom**

The feminine **n**-stems were originally declined like the masculine, as in Latin, Greek and Sanskrit, but already in the prehistoric period of the Germanic languages, they became differentiated in some of the cases by partly generalizing one or other of the forms, thus the nom. sing. originally ended in **-ō̃** or **-ōn** in both genders, the West Germanic languages restricted **-ō̃** to the masculine and **-ōn** to the feminine, but in Gothic the reverse took place. In the fem. Goth. O.Icel. OS. and OHG. levelled out the long vowel of the nom. into the oblique cases, whereas OE. had the same forms as the masculine except in the nom. sing. **-e** from prim. Germanic **-ōn** (§ **217**). The general remarks made in § **400** concerning the masculine **n**-stems also apply to the feminine.

The fem. nouns with short stems began to form their nom. sing. after the analogy of the short **ō**-stems (§ **365**) already in early OE., as **cinu,** *chink,* **spadu,** *spade,* beside **cine, spade.**

§ **404.** Like **tunge** are declined **ǣdre,** *artery, vein*; **ælmesse,** *alms*; **ǣsce,** *inquiry*; **ampre,** *sorrel*; **ar(e)we,** *arrow*; **asse,** *she-ass*; **asce,** *ash, cinders*; **āþexe,** *lizard*; **bǣcestre** (also masc.), *baker* (for other examples containing the suffix **-estre,** see § **603**); **bēce,** *beech-tree*; **belle,**

bell; **berige**, *berry*; **bīeme**, *trumpet*; **bicce**, *bitch*; **binde**, *head-band*; **blǣdre**, *bladder*; **blæse**, *blaze, firebrand, torch*; **burne**, *stream, brook*; **byrne**, *corslet*; **canne**, *can, cup*; **cēace**, *cheek, jaw*; **ceole**, *throat*; **cirice**, *church*; **clugge**, *bell*; **crāwe**, *crow*; **cuppe**, *cup*; **cūslyppe**, **-sloppe**, *cowslip*; **cwene**, *woman*; **docce**, *dock* (*plant*); **dūce**, *duck*; **eorþe**, *earth*; **fæcele**, *torch*; **faþe**, *aunt*; **fiþele**, *fiddle*; **flēoge**, *fly*; **flīete**, *cream*; **folde**, *earth*; **hacele**, *cloak*; **hearpe**, *harp*; **heofone**, *heaven*; **heorte** (orig. neut.), *heart*; **hlǣfdige**, *lady*; **hrūse**, *earth*; **loppe**, *flea*; **mǣge**, **māge**, *kinswoman*; **meowle**, *maiden*; **mīere**, *mare*; **mōdrige**, *maternal aunt*; **molde**, *earth*; **more**, *parsnip*; **moþþe**, *moth*; **nǣdre**, *snake*; **ōsle**, *ousel*; **panne**, *pan*; **pere**, *pear*; **pīpe**, *pipe*; **pirige**, *pear-tree*; **pise**, *pea*; **racente**, *chain*; **seohhe**, *sieve*; **sīde**, *side*; **slyppe**, *paste*; **smiþþe**, *smithy*; **sunne**, *sun*; **swealwe**, *swallow*; **swipe**, *scourge*; **þrote**, *throat*; **þyrne**, *thornbush*; **ūle**, *owl*; **wæcce** (§ **55**, Note 3), *vigil*; **wāse**, *mud*; **wicce**, *witch*; **wīse**, *way, manner*; **wice**, **wuce**, *week*; **wulle**, *wool*; **wuduwe**, *widow*; **ȳce**, *toad, frog*.

§ **405**. Like **bēo** are declined **cēo**, *jackdaw, chough*; **flā**, *arrow*; **sēo**, *pupil of the eye*; **slā**, **slāh**, *sloe*; **tā**, *toe*; **þō**, *clay*. See § **139**.

c. Neuter.

§ **406**.

	SING.		PLUR.
Nom. Acc.		**ēage**, *eye*	**ēagan**
Gen.		**ēagan**	**ēagena**
Dat.		**ēagan**	**ēagum**

The neuter **n**-stems had originally the same endings as the masculine and feminine except in the acc. sing. and the nom. acc. plural. The nom. acc. sing. had **-ōn** which regularly became **-e** in OE. (§ **217**). The nom. acc. pl. had **-ōnə** in the Indg. parent language. This was changed in prim. Germanic into **-ōnō** with **-ō** from the neuter **a**-stems. **-ōnō** regularly became **-ōna** in Goth., as **áugō**, *eye*, nom.

acc. pl. **áugōna.** The OE. ending **-an** was due to the analogy of the masc. and fem. **n**-stems.

§ **407.** Like **ēage** are only declined **ēare,** *ear*; **wange** (also with strong forms), *cheek.*

C. Minor Declensions.

1. Monosyllabic Consonant Stems.

a. Masculine.

§ **408.**

	Sing.	Plur.
Nom. Acc.	**fōt,** *foot*	**fēt**
Gen.	**fōtes**	**fōta**
Dat.	**fēt**	**fōtum**

The prim. Germanic forms were: Sing. nom. **fōt** for older ***fōs(s)** (Gr. Dor. πώς) with **t** from the inflected forms (§ **240**), and similarly **tōþ** for older ***tōs(s),** acc. ***fōtun** (Goth. **fōtu**), gen. ***fōtaz,** dat., properly loc., ***fōti**; Plur. nom. ***fōtiz,** acc. ***fōtunz** (Goth. **fōtuns**), gen. ***fōtõn,** dat. ***fōtumiz.** The OE. correspond to the prim. Germanic forms except in the gen. sing. which is a new formation after the analogy of the **a**-stems. The regular form would be ***fōt.**

§ **409.** Like **fōt** are declined **tōþ,** *tooth*; **man(n)** (beside **manna,** acc. **mannan, n**-declension), *man*; and **wīfman, wimman,** *woman.*

b. Feminine.

§ **410.**

	Sing.	
Nom. Acc.	**bōc,** *book*	**hnutu,** *nut*
Gen.	**bēc; bōce**	**hnute**
Dat.	**bēc**	**hnyte**

	Plur.	
Nom. Acc.	**bēc**	**hnyte**
Gen.	**bōca**	**hnuta**
Dat.	**bōcum**	**hnutum**

The OE. forms of **bōc** are regularly developed from prim. Germanic: Sing. nom. ***þōks**, acc. ***þōkun**, gen. ***þōkaz**, dat. ***þōki**; Plur. nom. ***þōkiz**, acc. ***þōkunz**, gen. ***þōkõn**, dat. ***þōkumiz**. The gen. sing. **bōce** was a new formation after the analogy of the **ō**-stems, and **bēc** is the dat. used for the gen. The regular nom. sing. of **hnutu** would be ***hnuss** (§ **240**), **hnutu** (prim. Germ. ***χnutun**) is the acc. used for the nominative. The gen. sing. was formed after the analogy of the **ō**-stems; the dat. sing. and nom. pl. correspond to prim. Germanic ***χnuti**, ***χnutiz**, the final **-i** (later **-e**) being retained after a short stem (§ **215**).

In nouns belonging to this class the stem-vowels **ā**, **ō**, **u**, **ū** were regularly umlauted to **ǣ**, **ē** (Nth. **œ**), **y**, **ȳ** in the dat. sing. and nom. acc. plural. In nearly all the nouns belonging to this class, beside the gen. sing. with umlaut there exists a form ending in **-e** without umlaut which was made after the analogy of the **ō**-stems. In late OE. the dat. sing. was often like the nominative.

§ **411.** Like **bōc** are declined **āc**, *oak*; **brōc**, *trousers*; **burg**, *city* (gen. dat. sing. and nom. acc. pl. **byrig** beside **byrg**, § **220**; also declined like **cwēn** (§ **389**), but without **i**-umlaut); **cū**, *cow* (also gen. sing. **cūe**, **cūs**; nom. acc. pl. **cȳ**, **cȳe**, gen. **cūa**, **cūna**, **cȳna**); **dung**, *prison*; **gāt**, *goat*; **gōs**, *goose*; **grūt**, *coarse meal, groats*; **lūs**, *louse*; **meol(u)c**, *milk*; **mūs**, *mouse*; **neaht**, **niht**, *night* (also gen. dat. sing. **nihte**; adv. gen. **nihtes**, **ānes nihtes**, *at night, by night*, formed after the analogy of **dæges**); **turf**, *turf*; **furh**, *furrow* (gen. sing. **fūre** beside **fyrh**, pl. gen. **fūra**, dat. **fūrum**, § **115**); **sulh**, *plough* (gen. sing. **sūles** on analogy with the **a**-stems, pl. gen. **sūla**, dat. **sūlum**); **þrūh**, *trough* (dat. pl. **þrūm**, § **329**); **wlōh**, *fringe*.

§ **412.** Like **hnutu** are declined **hnitu**, *nit*; **studu**, **stuþu**, *pillar*.